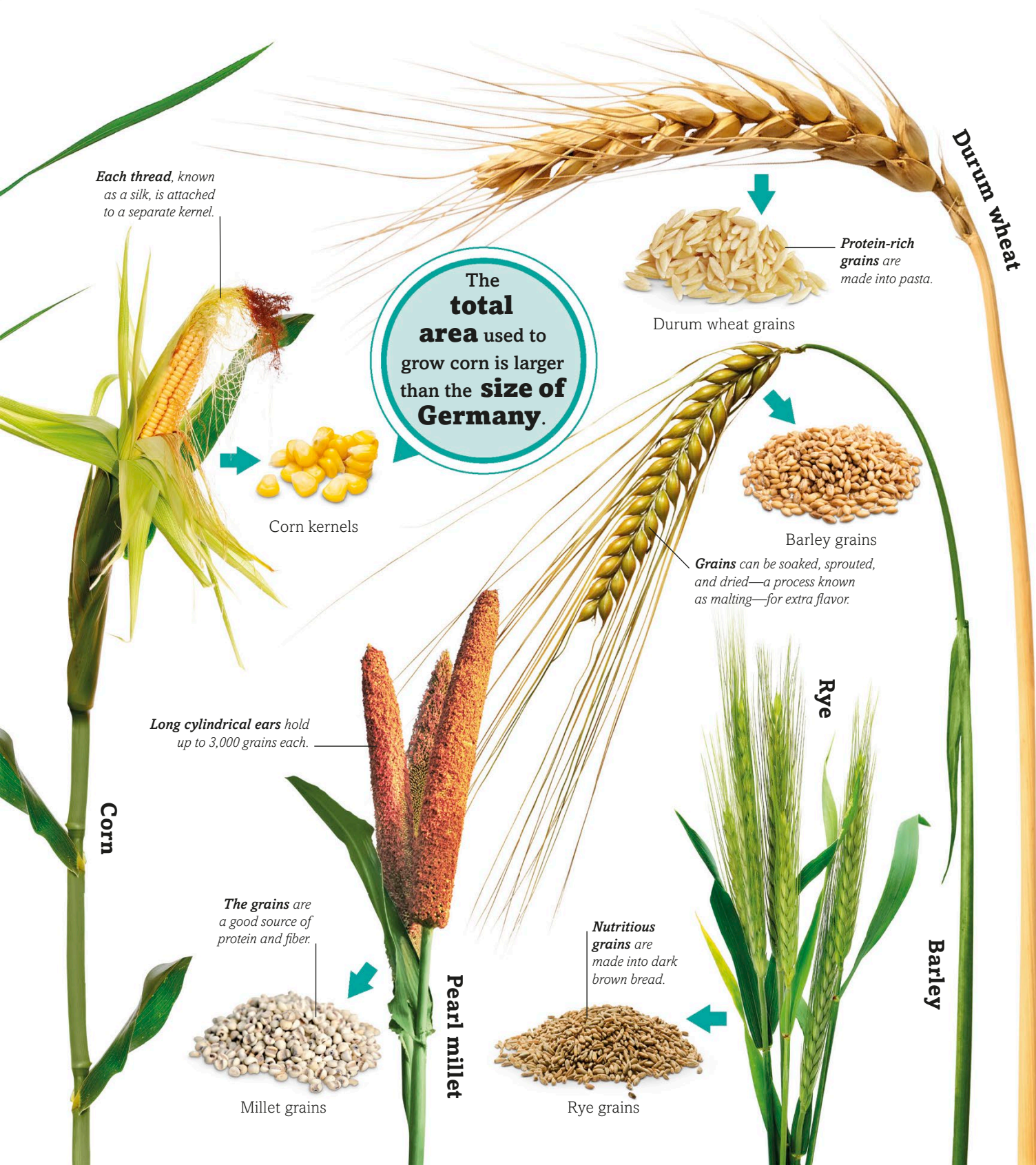




The most widely grown cereal plant is **corn**. Corn kernels are mainly used as cattle feed, or turned into a liquid biofuel called ethanol. Next comes **rice**, an essential food crop for more than half of the people on the planet, especially in Asia. **Wheat**, the third most important grain, is usually ground into flour and used to make bread

and pasta. **Barley**, which comes fourth, is used both for food and to make alcoholic drinks. Fifth is **sugarcane**, a large grass grown for its sweet sap, which is extracted by crushing the stems. The syrupy liquid is evaporated until it is so concentrated that it will harden when cooled, and the resulting solid is ground up into sugar crystals.



Each thread, known as a silk, is attached to a separate kernel.

The total area used to grow corn is larger than the size of Germany.

Protein-rich grains are made into pasta.

Durum wheat grains

Barley grains

Grains can be soaked, sprouted, and dried—a process known as malting—for extra flavor.

Rye

Barley

Long cylindrical ears hold up to 3,000 grains each.

Corn

The grains are a good source of protein and fiber.

Millet grains

Pearl millet

Nutritious grains are made into dark brown bread.

Rye grains